

A STUDY OF THE SACRED LITURGY

NOVUS ORDO, TRADITIONAL MASS, ORTHODOX LITURGY

A COMPARISON OF THE LITURGICAL FORMULA

— ORDO FIDELIUM CHRISTI —

NOVUS ORDO MASS <i>(Ordinary Form of the Roman Rite)</i> 	TRADITIONAL LATIN MASS <i>(Usus Antiquior / Tridentine Mass)</i> 	ORTHODOX DIVINE LITURGY <i>(Byzantine Tradition)</i> 
1. INTRODUCTORY RITES • Sign of the Cross • Greeting • Penitential Act • Kyrie • Gloria	1. PREPARATORY PRAYERS • Prayers at the Foot of the Altar • Confiteor • Kyrie • Gloria	1. PROKOMENIA (PROPAROCHETON) • Preparation of bread and wine • Commemorations of saints and the faithful
2. LITURGY OF THE WORD • Old Testament Reading • Psalm • Epistle • Gospel • Homily • Creed • Prayers of the Faithful	2. MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS • Epistle • Gospel • Sermon • Creed	2. LITURGY OF THE CATECHUMENS • Great Litany • Psalms and Antiphons • Little Entrance • Scripture Readings • Gospel • Homily
3. LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST • Presentation of Gifts • Eucharistic Prayer • Consecration • Memorial Acclamation • Lord's Prayer • Sign of Peace • Communion	3. MASS OF THE FAITHFUL • Offertory • Roman Canon • Consecration • Silent prayers of reverence • Pater Noster • Agnus Dei • Communion	3. LITURGY OF THE FAITHFUL • Great Entrance • Creed • Anaphora • Consecration / Epiclesis • Lord's Prayer • Communion
4. CONCLUDING RITE • Blessing • Dismissal	4. LAST GOSPEL & BLESSING • Final Blessing • Gospel of Saint John ("In the beginning was the Word...")	4. DISMISSAL • Blessings • Veneration • Distribution of blessed bread
SPIRITUAL CHARACTERISTICS • Vernacular language • Designed for active participation • Simplified structure • Multiple Eucharistic Prayers • Emphasis on accessibility 	SPIRITUAL CHARACTERISTICS • Latin language • Ad orientem worship • Sacred silence & mystery • Strong sacrificial emphasis • Ceremonial & structured 	SPIRITUAL CHARACTERISTICS • Ancient liturgical continuity • Chanting & sung responses • Incense & icons • Mystical & heavenly atmosphere • Emphasis on theosis (union with God) 

		THE FORMULA COMPARED			
		ELEMENT	NOVUS ORDO		
		Language	Vernacular	Latin	Greek / Slavonic / Vernacular
		Priest Direction	Usually facing people	Facing East	Facing East
		Chant	Optional	Strongly present	Central
		Silence	Moderate	Deeply emphasized	Less silent, more sung
		Eucharistic Prayer	Multiple forms	Roman Canon	Ancient Anaphora
		Congregational Response	Strong emphasis	Moderate	Sung participation
		Icons / Imagery	Moderate	Moderate	Extensive
		Incense	Optional	Frequent	Extensive
		Liturgical Length	Shorter	Moderate	Longer
		Spiritual Tone	Accessible	Sacrificial / Reverent	Mystical / Heavenly

THE ANCIENT ROOTS

The earliest Christian worship described in the Didache, the writings of Saint Justin Martyr, and the Apostolic Fathers already contained:



Scripture Readings



Prayers



Eucharistic Thanksgiving



Amen Responses



Bishops & Presbyters Leading Worship



Communion of the Faithful



Liturgical Order

THE HEART OF TRUE LITURGY

The outward form matters because worship teaches theology. Yet the deepest purpose of every true liturgy is:

WORSHIP OF THE HOLY TRINITY + REPENTANCE + COMMUNION WITH CHRIST + SANCTIFICATION OF THE FAITHFUL + PARTICIPATION IN THE KINGDOM OF GOD

The external formulas differ, yet all ancient Christian worship points toward Christ crucified, risen, and glorified.

As the Church Fathers taught: "The liturgy is heaven on earth."

TIKHON II ORDO FIDELIUM CHRISTI